

ENVIRON

- 10 things we did to **change** the environment
- 10 green **numbers**
- 10 most **popular** movements

Starting with the granddaddy of them all, Project Tiger in 1973, to the more recent vehicular pollution norms and the coming up of sustainable architecture, a green agenda has been part of governance much before it became a globally cool movement. Whether it was creating biosphere reserves or establishing the Ministry of Environment and Forests as well as Environment Impact Assessment Reports, the Government had intent, even if it didn't always have effect, as was clear in the Ganga Action Plan of 1985. The people haven't been passive observers either, spontaneously stepping in when those wielding political power did not seem to care. From the villagers of Garhwal hugging their trees to keep the axe away in the evocatively named Chipko movement to a 100-day long *padayatra* across the hills to save the Western Ghats to living for months in submerged homes in the Sardar Sarovar, people power stopped many disasters. There's a long way to go yet; the pressure of population on the environment is only growing, and there are new problems like global warming, but the road is mapped out.

THERE ARE 27 PROJECT TIGER WILDLIFE RESERVES COVERING AN AREA OF 37,761 KM.

